

JAMES UZMEN (AKA GIRAY)

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I am a highly experienced and versatile digital professional with extended experience of broad, cross-disciplinary work in graphic design, web development, IT, and media technologies. Possessing a unique blend of artistic vision and technical aptitude, adept at navigating complex technical environments and creatively solving problems. Proven ability to manage projects, collaborate with cross-functional teams, and deliver impactful digital solutions across various industries, including marketing, SEO, print and digital media, advertising, e-commerce, agency and development. Seeking to leverage extensive experience and diverse skill set in a challenging new role.

Skills and Achievements

- **Web Technologies:** HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, PHP, Python, Responsive UX/UI Design, SEO, Schema.org.
- **CMS Platforms:** WordPress, Documentum Web Publisher, Adobe Experience Manager (AEM), SiteCore/Vanilla, WPML, YOAST, WooCommerce, Elementor Pro and various WP themes.
- **Servers/Infrastructure/OS:** terminal, vi, bash, ffmpeg, rsync, OpenSSH, apache httpd, mod_rewrite, mod_ssl, expect, Linux admin (RedHat and Oracle), MariaDB, MySQL, Galera Replication, Akamai, CloudFlare, MaxMind Geo IP.
- **Software Proficiency:** MS Office, Windows, MacOS, XCode, Adobe Creative Suite, VS Code, BBEdit, vi and vim, Cursor App and Claude AI, Chrome Developer Tools, Gemini 2.5, VEO3, Adobe Photoshop AI.
- **Project & Team Collaboration:** Agile, Jira, V1. Successfully managed and collaborated on multiple large-scale digital projects, ensuring smooth transitions, fast delivery, optimal performance, and consistent uptime.
- **Problem Solving & Adaptation:** Developed robust technical solutions, including bespoke affiliate tracking systems and custom API integrations, by applying common sense, intuition, and research to adapt coding examples effectively.
- **Infrastructure Management:** Designed, implemented, and managed highly available, load balanced, quadruply redundant server infrastructure (making WordPress work across multiple centers and LINUX server VM clusters), while also prioritizing security against various online threats.
- **Content Management & Marketing:** Led initiatives to transform various WordPress platforms into major SEO and marketing tools, creating and maintaining blogs, designing CMS components/templates, email campaigns, responsive ads, and landing pages.
- **Localization:** Installed, maintained, and trained teams in WordPress Localization (WPML), successfully localizing numerous websites.

FREELANCE WEB DESIGN AND DEVELOPMENT - ONLINE GAMBLING - June 2025 to Present

- Freelance Chief Designer for online gambling and sportsbook company. Breathing life into a bland, proprietary, API-driven, non-editable website framework through heavy usage of CSS3. Corporate ID design, interfacing with the providers' dev and IT and SEO teams, designing promotion banners, creating online ads in static, animated GIF and video formats (using Gemini 2.5, Firefly 3, Nano Banana and VEO3 AI models) for marketing, especially on social media.

FREELANCE WEB DESIGN AND DEVELOPMENT - SABUNCAKIZ - 2024 to Present

- Designing and developing an online shop in WordPress and Woocommerce for 'Sabuncakiz's Hamam', a Turkish producer and physical shop specialising in exotic organic oils, soaps, cloths and candles. This site is now fully functional with payment processing, bespoke cargo integration, fully editable product catalogue, SEO, Woocommerce variable products and stock integration.

VOLUNTARY CHARITY WORK - THE IDEAS HUB - 2024 to Present

- Graphic Design and web design for Chelmsford based Charity 'The Ideas Hub': display graphics, leaflets, certificates, invitations, signage and presentation panels. Currently in the process of redesigning corporate identity, main website and designing and developing a website for their photography studio. Mentoring younger members of staff in graphic design, software and the use of AI for copy and images.

ENTAIN PLC (formerly PartyGaming, GVC and BWIN) - February 2006 to November 2024

- Managed multiple CMS platforms (Documentum Web Publisher, AEM, SiteCore / Vanilla) for flagship Poker product, collaborating with technical teams for design, development and performance optimization. Minimized business disruptions and supported content creators.
- Led the transition of a small side blog to into 7 multi-language blogs which became major SEO and marketing tools, designing and managing a highly available WordPress infrastructure. Prioritized security against various online attacks and created various notification mechanisms so the system ran itself 99% of the time.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams (SEO, Localization) to deliver websites, campaigns, and solutions. Implemented bespoke tracking systems, redirects, and marketing initiatives.
- Designed and implemented CMS components and templates, e-mail campaigns, responsive ad campaigns, landing pages, and bespoke SEO tracking systems.
- Collaborated with technical and design teams at sister company, Ivy Comptech, in Hyderabad, India.

AMPLEFUTURE (London) - 2005 to 2006

- Worked as a Web Designer and Developer, creating and maintaining websites for teens using a proprietary PHP development system. Websites included social media, mobile, and call centre tie-in technologies. Refactored and redesigned flagship website using HTML, PHP, JS, and CSS.

BLUE EDGED MEDIA (Southend-on Sea) - 2004 to 2005

- Designed and developed websites for financial services clients, banks and loan companies.
- Developed a JS and MS SQL-based glazing and window online sales application for Crittall Windows.
- Designed marketing e-mail campaigns and mailshots for loan companies.

CIRCLE.COM - Circle Euro RSCG (London) - 2003 to 2004

- Part-time contractor: Designed websites, interactive CDs and promotional videos for clients including HSBC, Peugeot, British Tourist Authority, London Tourist Board and Circle.com.

EGG INTERACTIVE (LONDON) - 2002 to 2003

- Web design and interactive media work, creating designs for Egg.com, Churchill Insurance and Baillie Gifford.

Education and Training

- **3 GCSEs including Maths and English** – British Council – Ankara, Turkey
- **4-year BA in Graphic Design, First Class Honours** - Hacettepe University – Ankara, Turkey

Additional Information

- Fully fluent in English. I also speak Turkish and French.
- British passport holder, legally entitled to work full-time in the UK.
- My main drive is the satisfaction of creating order out of chaos. I approach design and development holistically; not as competing disciplines but as sides of the same coin.
- Very good with stressful situations and hard deadlines.
- Highly motivated to learn new skills and information as needed to complete tasks.

References

References available on request.